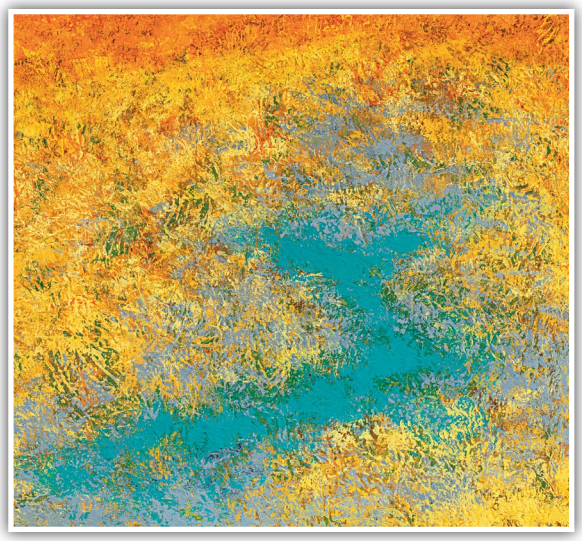




**MOTTLED COLOURS OF A FREE-FLOWING WORLD**
Two untitled paintings by Paramjit Singh from 2025

Through Paramjit Singh's landscapes—brimming with brooks, mountains and vast skies—the artist's profound affinity for the natural world becomes unmistakably clear. Growing up on the outskirts of Amritsar, Singh was surrounded by sprawling farms and nature rather than the noise of the city. These early years instilled in him a deep fondness for the outdoors, shaped by childhood walks and early trips into the mountains. Ultimately, these experiences did more than just influence his style; they stayed with him as an "inner light", making the nature he paints feel like a personal, quiet sanctuary.

The veteran artist, who has been painting for more than six decades, has a new exhibition titled *Liminal Geographies*, currently being showcased at Vadehra Art Gallery, with 18 new canvases created over the past year. It has been five years since Singh's solo exhibition at Triveni Kala Sangam in Delhi, and two years since his 2024 show in Mumbai. When asked how this latest collection differs from his past work, Singh suggests that his trajectory is more of a steady evolution than a sharp turn. For the past decade, his work has remained in the same atmospheric vein; yet, he notes that "little developments" and new inspirations constantly refine his visual language, allowing the work to mature without losing its foundational spirit.

Although he still relies on the brush to fill the canvas with broad, sweeping strokes, the 91-year-old painter lately finds his pigments becoming thicker and more voluminous; and so, he has been turning more to the palette knife. "While the brush is perfect for spreading colour, the palette knife allows me to build up the 'impasto' and give the paint its physical weight. In my process, the brush sets the foundation, but I use the palette knife to finish the work."

> The 91-year-old painter views the natural world as **something vast, asymmetrical** and constantly shifting

Singh has a unique way of approaching nature—sometimes with a touch of the surreal, other times with a sense of the supernatural. "For me, there is a certain drama in the natural world. I don't treat my paintings as mere scenes to be copied; instead, I use nature and pigment as my personal language. While my inspiration always comes from the world around me, I never aim to replicate it exactly," he says. When Singh finds a spot that moves him, he lets it settle in his mind until the minor details fade away and only the essence remains. "That essence becomes my starting point. From there, I develop an invented landscape—one that feels entirely natural, yet belongs completely to my own imagination," he shares.

Through his work, the artist strives to capture the "other" side of nature—the parts that are not immediately visible to